

Design principle (locked from this conversation)

Subscription gates features iLaunchify pays fixed cost to deliver. It does NOT gate the sales mechanisms (bulk or on-demand). Velocity tier sits on top of subscription tier — it rewards proven SKU velocity, regardless of subscription level.

That principle drives everything below.

Rebuilt tier table — V1.5 corrected

	Maker (free)	Builder (\$79/mo)	Agency (\$249/mo)
Who it's for	Creator evaluating their first bulk run	Real CPG business operator	Multi-brand operator / agency
Goal for us	Get them to first bulk order fast	Retain + grow per-creator volume	Portfolio scale + sales-touched
Subscription	\$0	\$79/mo (<i>was \$49 — Rec 3</i>)	\$249/mo (<i>was \$199 — Rec 3</i>)
Bulk orders	✓ Full access (<i>corrected</i>)	✓ Full access	✓ Full access
On-demand orders	✓ Full access	✓ Full access	✓ Full access
Velocity tier base fee	15%	10%	7%
Velocity tier floor (T5)	7%	5%	5% (was 3% — Rec 4)
Products	Unlimited (<i>locked per memory</i>)	Unlimited	Unlimited
Design Studio access	✓ Full	✓ Full	✓ Full
Compliance scan	✓ Required (we eat this cost)	✓ Full	✓ Full
Basic asset library (Iconify + Layer 1 regulatory)	✓ Full	✓ Full	✓ Full
Stock photography (Unsplash/Pexels free tier)	✓ Full	✓ Full	✓ Full

Shutterstock premium catalog (we pay \$200-500/mo)	—	✓ Full	✓ Full
AI Recipe Parser (Anthropic \$0.30/parse)	—	✓ 50/mo cap	✓ 200/mo cap
AI image generation (Replicate \$0.05/img)	—	✓ 20/mo cap	✓ 100/mo cap
Premium AI overage (beyond cap)	n/a	✓ \$1.50/gen	✓ \$1.50/gen
Channel push (Shopify / TikTok Shop / Amazon)	—	✓ Full	✓ Full
Custom fonts pinned to brand	—	✓ Full	✓ Full
Multi-brand management	1 brand	3 brands	Unlimited
Custom domain	—	—	✓
Bulk escrow opt-in (0.5% × value)	✓ available	✓ available	✓ available
Team seats	1	1	V1.5+ Creator Team model
Dedicated CSM	—	—	✓ at \$5k/mo+ usage
Custom Stripe contract	—	—	✓ sales-touched

What changed vs the originally-locked spec

Three deltas from the existing locked model:

1. Subscription prices raised (Rec 3)

- Builder: \$49 → \$79
- Agency: \$199 → \$249
- Reasoning: sub is 17% of customer LTV at Base assumptions. A 60% raise has negligible churn risk because velocity tier discount is doing the real upgrade incentive work.

2. Agency velocity tier floored at 5% (Rec 4)

- Was: Agency T4 = 4%, T5 = 3%
- New: Agency T4 = 5%, T5 = 5%
- Reasoning: 3% is below Stripe processing as a percentage. We're giving away compliance + orchestration at commodity rates. 5% is still 28% off the Agency base rate of 7% — meaningful reward, defensible margin.

3. Maker bulk access confirmed (drop Rec 5)

- Was implied in my critique: gate bulk to Builder+
- New: explicitly Maker has full bulk access
- Reasoning: the platform is bulk-first; gating bulk contradicts the value prop.

Everything else stays locked: 3-tier structure, velocity tier mechanics, cross-pollination, lower-of pricing, samples at Tier 1, partner-bundled accessories.

Upgrade triggers — what nudges Maker → Builder → Agency

These are SOFT triggers (UX prompts, not hard paywalls). They surface at the moment the creator demonstrates they need the feature.

Maker → Builder triggers (any one fires the upgrade prompt):

- 2nd brand created → "Manage multiple brands under one account"
- First channel push attempt → "Push your products to Shopify / TikTok Shop"
- First AI Recipe Parser click → "Parse recipes from any source with AI"
- First Shutterstock photo search → "Access 350M premium photos"
- First custom font search → "Pin custom fonts to your brand identity"
- 4th product created → "Manage your growing portfolio with Builder"

Note: **bulk orders do NOT trigger upgrade**. Maker doing a 200-unit bulk run is a happy path, not an upgrade moment.

Builder → Agency triggers:

- 4th brand created → "Multi-brand management is built for portfolios"
- AI quota exhausted 2+ months in a row → "Agency includes 4× the AI quota"
- 30+ orders/day sustained → "Agency includes dedicated CSM at this volume"
- Custom domain request → "Agency tier includes custom domain"
- Team seat invitation → "Add teammates with Agency"

Note: trigger language emphasizes UNLOCK, not COST. Creators see upside, not paywall.

How tier value actually splits

Three categories of value at each upgrade:

Maker → Builder (\$0 → \$79/mo = \$948/yr):

- Cost-bearing features iLaunchify provides: ~\$50-100/mo value (AI parser cost, Shutterstock seat allocation, image gen quota)
- Velocity-tier base rate compression: 15% → 10% = \$5 saved per \$100 of on-demand fee × Builder's typical volume (~\$240/mo of fees) = ~\$120/mo saved
- Channel push + brand sophistication: ~\$50/mo perceived value (vs paying for Shopify apps separately)
- **Total perceived value: ~\$220-270/mo against \$79/mo cost = 2.8-3.4× value/cost ratio** — strong upgrade economics

Builder → Agency (\$79 → \$249/mo = +\$2,040/yr):

- Larger AI/image quotas: ~\$50/mo additional cost-bearing value
- Velocity tier base 10% → 7% with 5% floor = ~\$80-150/mo saved at typical Agency volume
- Multi-brand management + custom domain + CSM at high volume: ~\$200/mo perceived
- **Total perceived value: ~\$330-400/mo against \$170/mo incremental cost = 2-2.4× value/cost ratio** — defensible upgrade but tighter

Velocity tier overlay (unchanged — already correct)

Sits on top of subscription tier. Per-SKU 30-day rolling volume → 5 tiers → fee % discount per tier per subscription tier. Cross-pollination: bulk volume counts toward on-demand tier. Lower-of pricing. Samples at Tier 1.

Effective creator-side fees after velocity layering (volume-weighted):

Tier	Locked V1.5 base	After Rec 4 floor at 5%
Maker	14.76%	14.76% (no change — floor doesn't bind)
Builder	8.92%	8.92% (no change — floor doesn't bind)
Agency	5.62%	5.83% (floor adds back ~0.2pp on high-volume Agencies)

Floor at 5% is small in expectation but defends margin at the tail.

Diversified revenue streams per tier (Rec 2, 7, 8)

Beyond subscription + variable fees:

Stream	Maker	Builder	Agency
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Float income on held balances	✓ (auto-applied to all flows)	✓	✓
Bulk escrow opt-in (0.5%)	✓ available	✓ available	✓ available
Premium AI overage (\$1.50/gen)	n/a	✓ above cap	✓ above cap
Partner referral attribution	n/a (partner-side)	—	—

Float income flows automatically — no tier-gating, no UX work. Bulk escrow is an optional checkbox at bulk checkout. Premium AI overage requires hitting the cap (engineered prompt at 90% cap: "buy more credits").

What this looks like as a creator journey

Day 1 — Sign up as Maker. Free. Design studio access. Pick a marketplace product. Run a 50-unit on-demand test to a personal address. Pay 15% platform fee.

Day 30 — First bulk consideration. Maker sees 200-unit run priced at 15% fee + lower wholesale = much better unit economics. Decides to commit. Runs the bulk. iLaunchify takes ~\$175 of platform fees. Maker now has 250 units sold, evaluating Shopify channel push.

Day 35 — Tries to push to Shopify. Soft upgrade prompt: "Channel push is a Builder feature. Builder also unlocks AI Recipe Parser, Shutterstock catalog, custom fonts pinned to your brand. Try Builder for \$79/mo." Maker converts.

Day 90 — Builder running steady on-demand + monthly bulk. Cherry SKU hits Velocity Tier 3 (247 units past 30d). Effective fee drops to 7%. Notification: "Your Cherry SKU just unlocked Tier 3 pricing."

Day 180 — Adding second brand. Soft upgrade prompt at 3rd brand: "Manage unlimited brands with Agency." Maybe converts to Agency, maybe stays at 3 brands on Builder. Either way, hooked.

Why this rebuild is structurally better

Three reasons the new model is more sustainable than the originally-locked spec:

Aligned with how the platform actually works. Bulk-first orientation means Maker bulk orders are happy-path transactions, not loss-leaders. Every order at every tier contributes revenue.

Gates the right things. Cost-bearing features (AI, Shutterstock, channel integrations) sit behind paid tiers. Sales mechanisms (bulk + on-demand) are universal. We earn from every transaction; we cover our fixed costs from subscriptions.

Defensible at the top. 5% velocity floor on Agency means even at Tier 5 we capture meaningful margin on the highest-revenue creators. The 3% floor in the originally-locked spec turned high-volume Agencies into break-even customers; the 5% floor makes them the most profitable.

What this means for the V1.5 spec docs

Three small documentation updates needed:

1. **on-demand-pricing-economics.md** — add the V1.5 addendum: Maker has full bulk access; Agency velocity floor at 5%; Builder \$79 / Agency \$249.
2. **_V1.5_VELOCITY_PRICING.md** — confirm velocity floor at 5% across all tiers at Tier 5 in the table.
3. **Memory file ilaunchify-tier-philosophy-bulk-first.md** — lock the principle: "subscription gates features iLaunchify pays fixed cost to deliver; never gates the sales mechanisms (bulk or on-demand)."

Want me to write those three updates as docs you can commit, and update the simulation script to use the corrected tier model? That'd give you a clean baseline going forward.